Poisonous personalities

Some reptiles are "venomous." This means they are able to produce a poisonous fluid (venom) that can either be used for hunting or defense. A reptile's venom can paralyze its prey – or break down its blood and muscles, ready for eating.



Poisoning prey

Venomous snakes put poison into the body of their prey through hollow, stabbing teeth called fangs. The venom overpowers the victim and stops it from fighting back.

Nasty spit

All cobras have fixed fangs at the front of the mouth. Some use these for spitting venom into the face of their enemies – a defense strategy that can cause lots of pain, and even blindness.

Spitting cobras can aim at enemy targets...

Spitting black cobra